从一道划痕到天花绝迹

From a Scratch to a World Without Smallpox



詹纳不是第一人，贡献究竟在哪里？

英文原文

Smallpox, a **contagious affliction**, killed about three in ten of its **sufferers** and an estimated 300 million in the 20th century. An early **safeguard**, **deliberately implanting matter** from its **sores** in the healthy, was **practised** in China by the 16th century and reached England in 1721. The **procedure** itself could cause **grave sickness** or death, if less **frequently** than natural smallpox.

Rustic lore held that milkmaids with cowpox, a **mild ailment** of **livestock**, were **immune to** smallpox. In 1774 Benjamin Jesty, a Dorset farmer, **employed** cowpox to protect his wife and two sons. On 14 May 1796 Edward Jenner, a **provincial practitioner**, **inserted fluid** from a milkmaid's cowpox sore into a **scratch** on eight-year-old James Phipps.

On 1 July 1796 Jenner **exposed** the boy **to** smallpox; no **symptoms ensued**. In 1797 the Royal Society declined to **publish** his paper, judging his evidence **unconvincing**. In June 1798 he **privately funded** his book, the Inquiry, with **supplementary** cases. The word **vaccine derives from** the **Latin** vacca, cow.

Jenner was not the idea's **originator**. His contribution was a test, with results **accessible** in print, so other doctors could **replicate** and **disseminate** the **technique**. By today's standards, **experimentation** on a child without **informed consent** would be **unethical**. Jenner died on 26 January 1823, with smallpox far from **eliminated**.

In 1967 the WHO launched an **intensified**, **concerted** campaign to **eradicate** smallpox. The last **naturally occurring** case was **diagnosed** in Somalia on 26 October 1977. On 8 May 1980 the World Health Assembly **formally** declared the world free of smallpox, the only human disease ever **wiped out**. That **pronouncement** came almost 184 years after Phipps was **vaccinated**.

中文译文

天花，一种传染性的疾病，夺去了约三成患者的生命，并且估计有3亿人在20世纪丧命。一种早期的防护手段，是有意把天花脓疮中的物质植入健康人体内，到16世纪，中国已在施行这种方法，1721年又传入英国。这种做法本身可能导致严重的疾病或死亡，尽管不如自然天花那样频繁。

乡间传说认为，挤奶女工若得过牛痘这种牲畜的轻微病症，就对天花免疫。1774年，本杰明·杰斯蒂，一位多塞特郡农夫，使用牛痘来保护他的妻子和两个儿子。1796年5月14日，爱德华·詹纳，一位地方执业医师，将取自一名挤奶女工牛痘疮的液体，注入8岁的詹姆斯·菲普斯的一道划痕中。

1796年7月1日，詹纳让这个男孩接触天花；任何症状都没有随之出现。1797年，皇家学会拒绝去发表他的论文，认为他的证据缺乏说服力。1798年6月，他私人出资出版了他的著作《探究》，书中附上了补充病例。表示疫苗的英文词源自拉丁语的vacca，意思是牛。

詹纳并不是这一想法的首创者。他的贡献是一项试验，其结果在已出版的书籍中可以获得，以便其他医生能够复制并传播这项技术。按今天的标准，拿孩子做实验在没有取得知情同意的情况下，属于不道德行为。詹纳于1823年1月26日去世，那时天花还远未被消除。

1967年，世界卫生组织发起了一场强化、共同筹划的运动，要根除天花。最后一例自然发生的病例于1977年10月26日在索马里确诊。1980年5月8日，世界卫生大会正式宣布全世界已摆脱天花，天花也成为迄今唯一被彻底消灭的人类疾病。那一宣告，出现在菲普斯接种疫苗之后的近184年。

词汇与表达

Smallpox n.
天花

contagious adj.
传染性的
Smallpox, a contagious affliction,

affliction n.
疾病
Smallpox, a contagious affliction,

sufferers n.
患者

safeguard n.
防护手段
safeguard, deliberately implanting

deliberately adv.
有意

implanting v.
植入
safeguard, deliberately implanting

matter n.
物质

sores n.
脓疮

practised v.
施行

procedure n.
做法
The procedure itself could cause grave

grave adj.
严重的
itself could cause grave sickness or

sickness n.
疾病

frequently adv.
频繁

Rustic adj.
乡间

lore n.
传说

mild adj.
轻微

ailment n.
病症

livestock n.
牲畜

immune to adj.
对……免疫
of livestock, were immune to smallpox.

employed v.
使用

provincial adj.
地方

practitioner n.
执业医师
Jenner, a provincial practitioner,

inserted v.
注入

fluid n.
液体

scratch n.
划痕

exposed to v.
让……接触

symptoms n.
症状

ensued v.
随之出现
no symptoms ensued.

词汇与表达（续）

publish v.
发表

unconvincing adj.
缺乏说服力

privately adv.
私人

funded v.
出资

supplementary adj.
补充
with supplementary cases.

vaccine n.
疫苗
The word vaccine derives from the

derives from v.
源自

Latin n.
拉丁语

originator n.
首创者
Jenner was not the idea's originator.

accessible adj.
可以获得
was a test, with results accessible in

replicate v.
复制
so other doctors could replicate and

disseminate v.
传播
could replicate and disseminate the

technique n.
技术

experimentation n.
实验

informed adj.
知情
on a child without informed consent

consent n.
同意
on a child without informed consent

unethical adj.
不道德
would be unethical.

eliminated v.
消除

intensified adj.
强化

concerted adj.
共同筹划的
an intensified, concerted campaign to

eradicate v.
根除
campaign to eradicate smallpox.

naturally adv.
自然

occurring v.
发生

diagnosed v.
确诊
was diagnosed in Somalia on 26 October

formally adv.
正式

wiped out phr.
彻底消灭

pronouncement n.
宣告
That pronouncement came almost 184

vaccinated v.
接种疫苗

文章简述

- 背景：天花约致三成患者死亡；早期人痘术把天花疮中物质接种给健康人作预防，风险虽低于自然染病，仍可能致重病或死亡。
- 先例：乡间传牛痘可防天花；农夫杰斯蒂1774年已用牛痘保护家人，詹纳并非首创。
- 试验：詹纳1796年给男孩种牛痘，再让他接触天花而未发病；无知情同意的儿童试验按今天标准不合伦理。
- 推广：皇家学会嫌证据不足拒稿后，詹纳自费公布试验和补充病例，使其他医生能够重复验证、传播技术。
- 根除：世卫1967年强化行动，1977年出现最后自然病例；1980年世界卫生大会宣布根除天花，迄今唯一被根除的人类疾病。